Contours or just click on the “From Contours” button in the Sandbox toolbar. SketchUp instantly creates a terrain by using the contour lines you’ve drawn as guides and filling in the spaces in between (or, if it’s a complex set of contours, may take a few seconds for calculations before creating a TIN out of them).

5.4. Sandbox From Scratch

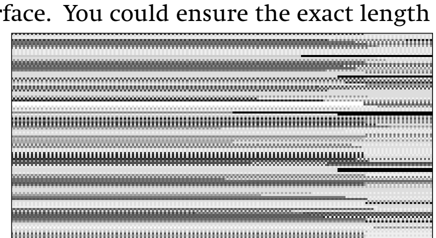
If you’re mouse-happy fingers are a bit sad and you’re not itching to scribble, SketchUp let’s you scratch up a Sandbox without much labour. Use it to make flat TINs along the ground plane. You can activate the Sandbox from Scratch Tool from the Draw menu (Draw > Sandbox > Scratch) or just the click on the button that shows you a flat grid in the Sandbox toolbar.

What the Sandbox from Scratch basically does, is help you make a flat Triangulated Irregular Network—in this case, a quadrilateral—by allowing you to create a bounded space made up of 10 feet square grids. You could enter a value in the VCB to change the grid size before you complete the action of creating the Sandbox. You could even change the size of every individual square in the grid using the VCB.

5.4.1. Scratching the Surface

Let us, quite literally, start from scratch. To create a TIN using the “Sandbox from Scratch” tool, just do this:

- Activate the Sandbox From Scratch Tool (as delineated above). The cursor now turns into a pencil with a grid floating about.
- Click once, to start the TIN and drag the mouse to establish the length of the surface. You could ensure the exact length of the line by specifying the length of the line in the VCB.
- Click (or press [Enter] if you’re using the VCB). The length of one edge of your TIN is



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